

KALEB SOFER

MACHINE LEARNING ENGINEER

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Senior engineer with six years' experience designing and delivering scalable, production-grade data systems, spanning the full lifecycle from infrastructure and ETL to user-facing ML models and visualisation. Consulting for both start-ups and established businesses has built a strong track record of leading multidisciplinary teams.

I run **Softmax Ltd**, a data and AI practice taking clients from initial AI strategy through to shipped products. I also lecture and mentor Level 6 Machine Learning apprentices at Founders and Coders, where I am due to complete the same part-time programme this year.

TECHNICAL STACK

LANGUAGES & ENGINEERING

Python, SQL, Bash, Linux, Git; data structures and algorithms, automated testing, profiling and performance optimisation.

ML FRAMEWORKS & APPLIED ML

PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, NumPy, pandas; feature engineering, supervised and unsupervised learning, hyperparameter optimisation and model calibration.

PRODUCT ML & ARCHITECTURES

Ranking, recommendation, candidate retrieval, embeddings, two-tower models, approximate nearest-neighbour search, FAISS; transformers, CNNs and recurrent networks.

EVALUATION & EXPERIMENTATION

Cross-validation, leakage prevention, cohort analysis, A/B testing and causal inference; PR-AUC, ROC-AUC, NDCG, Recall@K; Matplotlib, Plotly, Power BI.

DATA, PIPELINES & ORCHESTRATION

Spark, Kafka, BigQuery, relational and NoSQL stores; batch and streaming pipelines, data validation, Great Expectations; Airflow, Prefect, Kubeflow, automated retraining and dataset versioning.

PLATFORM, TRAINING & SERVING

GCP, AWS, Azure, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes; distributed training with PyTorch DDP/FSDP, mixed precision, quantisation and distillation; FastAPI, ONNX Runtime, CI/CD; MLflow, W&B, model registries and drift monitoring.

INTERESTS

Saxophonist and music producer; qualified sailing skipper, keen swimmer, injured footballer.

EXPERIENCE

SOFTMAX LTD

Jun 2024 – Present

Founding Director

Lead client acquisition, technical discovery and delivery for a data and AI practice. Scope engagements, set technical direction and oversee development of client systems and in-house products.

FOUNDERS AND CODERS via Softmax

Jan 2026 – Jul 2026

Senior ML Engineer

Built an organisation-wide RAG system letting clients, staff and learners query institutional knowledge. Designed and delivered applied ML and infrastructure modules for the Level 6 apprenticeship, running weekly workshops for 20–40 experienced engineers.

TRACTION

Jul 2025 – Present

Founder & Sole Engineer

Designed, built and launched a productivity and wellness app on iOS and Android, taking it from concept to beta with a few hundred active testers to date.

MADETECH

Mar 2022 – Apr 2024

Ministry of Justice

Jul 2023 – Apr 2024

Senior Data Engineer

Led the data engineering team through a large court-case migration, implementing an Apache Iceberg data lake on AWS, PySpark pipelines, live data linkage and services supporting front-end development.

DVLA

Mar 2022 – Jun 2023

Senior Engineer

Lead a team building a Databricks analytics platform on Azure, provisioning infrastructure with Terraform and integrating data sources through PySpark pipelines to support reliable Power BI dashboards.

KUBRICK

Mar 2019 – Nov 2021

Santander

Aug 2020 – Nov 2021

Data Scientist, Financial Crime

Developed and deployed an anti-money laundering tool using anomaly detection and NLP to accelerate investigations. Used daily by 400 analysts, saving £12m annually. Built with PySpark, PyTorch and spaCy.

Deliveroo

Jun 2019 – Jun 2020

Data Engineer, Payments

Built a flexible restaurant payouts platform to support cash flow through COVID-19 lockdowns, using Python and SQL, with Docker deployment and pipelines on AWS and Snowflake.

EDUCATION

Level 6 ML Engineering Apprenticeship

Founders and Coders
Jan 2026 – Present

Advanced AI Bootcamp

The Machine Learning Institute
Sep – Dec 2024

B.Eng. Aerospace Engineering

University of Manchester
First Class Honours